

I'll keep **wage** at the same full-family standard and distinguish its two major worlds very clearly:
noun = payment for labour, versus **verb** = conduct/fight a war, campaign, struggle, etc. I'll also keep the older/rare senses visible rather than silently dropping them.

Word family: **wage / wages / waged / waging / wageless / wage-earner / wage-earning**

Base word: wage

Plural: wages

Verb forms: wages, waged, waging

Major related/compound forms:

- * wages
- * wage-earner
- * wage-earning
- * wage labour / wage labor
- * wage worker
- * low-wage
- * high-wage
- * wageless — uncommon
- * wage bill
- * wage rate
- * wage level
- * wage increase / rise
- * wage cut
- * wage freeze
- * wage cap
- * wage floor
- * wage restraint
- * wage bargaining
- * wage settlement
- * wage claim
- * wage arrears
- * wage theft
- * minimum wage
- * living wage
- * prevailing wage
- * nominal wage
- * real wage
- * efficiency wage
- * reservation wage
- * wage differential
- * wage premium
- * wage gap
- * wage compression
- * wage dispersion

- * wage inflation
- * wage-price spiral
- * wage rigidity
- * wage indexation
- * wage share
- * wage subsidy
- * wage replacement
- * wage garnishment
- * wage deduction
- * back wages
- * wage costs
- * unit labour/labor cost
- * wage war
- * wage a campaign
- * wage a struggle
- * wage battle

****Part of speech:**** noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your passage:

> “...rent, renovation costs, staff ****wages****, food waste...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****wages**** means:

> ****money a café pays its employees in return for their work, forming part of the café’s ongoing labour cost.****

****繁體中文：****

* ****工資****

* ****薪酬****

* ****員工工資****

So:

> “staff wages”

= ****「員工工資」 / 「員工薪酬」****

The passage lists them alongside:

- * rent;
- * renovation;

- * food waste;
- * licensing;
- * suppliers,

to show that a café has substantial operating expenses.

The ILO uses **wages** broadly for remuneration or earnings payable by an employer to an employed person for work done or services rendered. ([International Labour Organization][1])

A. WAGE = PAYMENT FOR WORK

1. **wage** = money paid to an employee for work (工資 ; 薪酬)

This is the core noun meaning.

> “The job pays a good wage.”

「這份工作提供不錯的**工資**。」

> “Workers demanded higher wages.”

「工人要求提高**工資**。」

Historically and traditionally, **wage** is especially associated with pay calculated:

- * hourly;
- * daily;
- * weekly;
- * by output/piece,

although modern business/legal usage can be broader. Dictionaries still contrast it conventionally with **salary**, while acknowledging overlap. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

B. SINGULAR **WAGE** VS PLURAL **WAGES**

2. **a wage** = a particular rate/amount of pay

> “She earns a wage of \$20 an hour.”

「她每小時工資為 20 美元。」

3. **wages = the money received as employment pay**

> “His wages are paid every Friday.”

「他的**工資**每星期五發放。」

The plural is especially common when talking about:

> actual pay received.

C. HOURLY / DAILY / WEEKLY WAGE

4. **hourly wage = 時薪**

> “The hourly wage is \$18.”

「時薪是 18 美元。」

5. **daily wage = 日薪**

6. **weekly wage = 週薪**

7. **monthly wage = 月薪**

Possible, though **monthly salary** may be more conventional for salaried professional roles.

8. **annual wage**

Possible statistically/accountingly, although **annual salary** or **annual earnings** is often more natural depending on employment type.

D. WAGE RATE

9. **wage rate = amount of pay per unit of time/output (工資率) **

Examples:

* \$20 per hour;

* \$160 per day;

* amount per unit produced.

> “The wage rate increased.”

「**工資率**提高了。」

E. PIECE-RATE WAGE

10. **piece-rate pay / piece wage = 按件工資**

Payment determined by:

> quantity of output completed

rather than only time worked.

11. **piecework wages**

= 按完成件數計算的工資.

F. BASIC WAGE

12. **basic wage = 基本工資**

Core contractual wage before various additions such as:

* overtime;

* bonuses;

* allowances,

depending on payroll system.

G. GROSS WAGES

13. **gross wages = deductions前的工資總額 (工資總額) **

Broadly:

> earnings before applicable deductions.

Exact payroll definitions depend on jurisdiction.

H. NET WAGES

14. **net wages = deductions後實收工資 (淨工資) **

After applicable deductions such as:

- * tax;
- * social contributions;
- * other lawful deductions.

I. TAKE-HOME PAY

15. **take-home pay ≠ gross wage**

gross wage

deductions前.

take-home pay

actual amount employee receives after deductions.

繁體中文： ** **實收薪金

J. LOW / HIGH WAGES

16. **low wages = 低工資**

> “The sector is known for low wages.”

「這個行業以**低工資**聞名。」

17. **high wages = 高工資**

K. DECENT WAGE

18. **decent wage = 足以被認為合理、體面的工資**

A broad evaluative phrase rather than one universally fixed legal amount.

> “Workers want a decent wage.”

「工人希望獲得**合理而足夠的薪酬**。」

L. FAIR WAGE

19. **fair wage = 公平工資**

Implies pay regarded as equitable given:

- * work;
- * skills;
- * conditions;
- * comparison group,

but there is no single universal lexical formula.

M. MINIMUM WAGE

20. **minimum wage = legally/institutionally required minimum remuneration (最低工資) **

The ILO defines a minimum wage broadly as the minimum amount an employer is required to pay wage earners for work during a specified period and which cannot simply be reduced by individual or collective agreement where the rule applies. ([International Labour Organization][3])

繁體中文：*最低工資**

21. **statutory minimum wage = 法定最低工資**

A minimum wage specifically established through law/regulatory machinery.

22. **minimum wage rate = 最低工資水平 / 工資率**

N. LIVING WAGE

23. **living wage = wage level intended to support a decent standard of living (生活工資) **

The ILO's current formulation describes it in relation to the wage level needed for workers and their families to afford a decent standard of living, taking account of country circumstances and normal working hours. ([International Labour Organization][4])

Important:

> **living wage ≠ automatically the same thing as statutory minimum wage.**

A legal minimum may be above, equal to, or below a particular living-wage estimate depending on system and methodology.

O. MINIMUM WAGE VS LIVING WAGE

minimum wage

legal/institutional minimum payable.

living wage

needs-based concept concerning a decent standard of living.

They can overlap but should not be automatically merged.

P. PREVAILING WAGE

24. **prevailing wage = typical/required wage for work in a particular occupation/location under a specified system (通行工資) **

Especially used in:

- * labour-market analysis;
- * public procurement;
- * regulated contract contexts.

Exact legal meaning varies by jurisdiction.

Q. MARKET WAGE

25. **market wage = wage produced/observed in a labour market (市場工資) **

Can refer to:

> typical pay determined by supply/demand and bargaining conditions for comparable labour.

R. STARTING WAGE

26. **starting wage = 入職起薪**

> “The starting wage is \$17 per hour.”

「起薪為每小時 17 美元。」

S. ENTRY-LEVEL WAGE

27. **entry-level wage = 初級職位工資**

T. WAGE INCREASE / RISE

28. **wage increase = 工資增加**

> “Employees received a 5% wage increase.”

「員工獲得 5% **加薪**。」

29. **wage rise = 加薪 / 工資上升**

Especially common BrE.

U. PAY RAISE VS WAGE RISE

pay raise

especially AmE.

wage rise

especially BrE/economic reporting.

Both broadly mean:

> compensation increased.

V. WAGE CUT

30. **wage cut = 減薪**

> “The company introduced wage cuts.”

「公司實施**減薪**。」

W. WAGE FREEZE

31. **wage freeze = 工資凍結**

A policy/decision not to increase wages for a period.

> wages stay at current nominal level.

X. WAGE CAP

32. **wage cap = 工資上限**

A limit placed on wage increases or wage levels under a particular rule/system.

Y. WAGE FLOOR

33. **wage floor = 工資下限**

Minimum permitted/accepted wage level.

A statutory minimum wage can function as a wage floor.

Z. WAGE RESTRAINT

34. **wage restraint = 工資增長抑制 / 薪酬克制**

Policy or negotiated practice of limiting wage growth.

AA. WAGE CONTROL

35. **wage controls = 工資管制**

Rules/measures limiting how wages can change.

Specialist macroeconomic/labour-policy term.

AB. WAGE NEGOTIATION

36. **wage negotiation = 工資談判**

Negotiating:

* rates;

* increases;

* conditions.

AC. WAGE BARGAINING

37. **wage bargaining = 工資協商**

Can occur:

* individually;

* collectively.

AD. COLLECTIVE WAGE BARGAINING

38. **collective bargaining over wages = 集體工資談判**

Workers/unions and employers negotiate compensation and related employment conditions.

AE. WAGE DEMAND

39. **wage demand = 加薪 / 工資要求**

> “The union submitted a wage demand.”

「工會提出**工資要求**。」

AF. WAGE CLAIM

40. **wage claim = 工資要求 / 欠薪申索**

Two common contexts:

industrial relations

claim for higher wages.

legal/employment

claim for unpaid/underpaid wages.

Context decides.

AG. WAGE SETTLEMENT

41. **wage settlement = 工資協議**

An agreement resolving wage negotiations.

AH. WAGE AGREEMENT

42. **wage agreement = 工資協議**

Agreement covering rates/pay conditions.

AI. WAGE SCALE

43. **wage scale = 工資等級表**

Structured rates according to:

- * grade;
- * experience;
- * job category.

AJ. WAGE BAND

44. **wage band = 工資範圍 / 薪酬帶**

A permitted/typical pay range.

salary band is often more common for professional jobs.

AK. WAGE DIFFERENTIAL

45. **wage differential = 工資差異**

Difference in wages between:

- * occupations;
- * skills;

- * regions;
- * shifts;
- * groups.

AL. WAGE PREMIUM

46. **wage premium = 額外工資 / 工資溢價**

Extra pay associated statistically or contractually with some characteristic, such as:

- * qualification;
- * skill;
- * shift;
- * hazardous work;
- * location.

Example:

- > union wage premium
- > education wage premium.

AM. SHIFT DIFFERENTIAL

47. **shift differential / shift premium = 輪班津貼 / 額外工資**

Additional pay for working:

- * nights;
- * weekends;
- * undesirable shifts.

Related to wages but usually classified separately as a premium/addition.

AN. OVERTIME WAGES

48. **overtime wages/pay = 加班工資**

Pay for work beyond ordinary hours, possibly at a higher applicable rate.

Exact entitlement depends on contract/law.

AO. WAGE BILL

49. **wage bill = employer's total wage expenditure (工資總支出) **

Very relevant to the café passage.

> “The restaurant's wage bill is rising.”

「餐廳的**工資總支出**正在上升。」

For Kam Chai:

> staff wages collectively form part of the café's **wage bill**.

AP. WAGE COST

50. **wage cost = employer cost attributable to wages (工資成本) **

Plural:

> wage costs.

AQ. LABOUR COST VS WAGE COST

wage cost

direct wages/pay.

labour cost

may include broader employer costs such as:

- * wages/salaries;
- * benefits;
- * employer contributions;
- * payroll taxes,

depending on accounting definition.

So:

> **labour cost can be broader than wages.**

AR. WAGE SHARE

51. **wage share = portion of income/output going to labour compensation (工資份額) **

Macroeconomics/labour economics.

Older economic usage also uses **wages** collectively for labour's share of production/income as distinct from returns to capital. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

AS. WAGE EARNER

52. **wage earner = person earning employment wages (工薪人士 ; 工資勞動者) **

> "The tax affects many low-wage earners."

「該稅項影響很多**低薪工薪人士**。」

AT. WAGE-EARNING

53. **wage-earning = earning money through paid employment (以工資為收入的) **

> wage-earning workers

AU. WAGE WORKER

54. **wage worker = person working for wages (受薪工人) **

Common in:

* economics;

* labour history;

* sociology.

AV. WAGE LABOUR / WAGE LABOR

55. **wage labour = system/work in which labour is exchanged for wages (僱傭勞動) **

BrE:

> wage labour

AmE:

> wage labor.

AW. WAGE EMPLOYMENT

56. **wage employment = 受僱領薪的就業形式**

Contrasted with:

- * self-employment;
- * unpaid family work;
- * some forms of independent contracting.

The ILO notes that wages in its general employment sense concern employer-to-employee remuneration rather than self-employment income. ([International Labour Organization][1])

AX. WAGE INCOME

57. **wage income = 工資收入**

Income derived from paid employment.

AY. WAGE VS SELF-EMPLOYMENT INCOME

Kam Chai's passage actually contains this shift:

current job

receives wages/salary.

café owner

may receive:

- * business profit;
- * owner's drawings;
- * salary from own company,
depending on legal/business structure.

So:

> café revenue $\neq$ automatically Kam Chai's "wage."

AZ. NOMINAL WAGE

58. **nominal wage = money wage expressed in current currency amounts (名義工資) **

Example:

> \$20/hour.

It does not adjust for changes in prices.

BA. REAL WAGE

59. **real wage = wage adjusted for purchasing power/inflation (實質工資) **

The U.S. BLS describes **real earnings** as earnings adjusted for inflation, indicating purchasing power after price changes. The same underlying distinction supports **real wage** terminology. ([Bureau of Labor Statistics][5])

BB. NOMINAL VS REAL WAGE

Example:

> wage rises 3%

> prices rise 5%.

Nominal wage increased, but:

> purchasing power may decline.

So:

nominal

money amount.

real

what that money can buy.

BC. REAL WAGE GROWTH

60. **real wage growth = inflation-adjusted increase in wages (實質工資增長) **

BD. WAGE GROWTH

61. **wage growth = 工資增長**

Rate at which wages rise over time.

Can refer to:

* nominal;

* real,

so context matters.

BE. WAGE INFLATION

62. **wage inflation = broad sustained increase in wage rates (工資通脹 / 工資上漲) **

Macroeconomic/labour-market term.

BF. WAGE-PRICE SPIRAL

63. **wage-price spiral = wages and prices repeatedly pushing each other upward (工資—物價

螺旋) **

Conceptually:

- > higher prices → wage demands
- > higher labour costs → price increases
- > potentially repeated.

This is an economic mechanism/hypothesis; whether it explains a particular inflation episode is empirical and context-dependent.

BG. WAGE RIGIDITY

64. **wage rigidity = wages do not adjust quickly/easily to economic conditions (工資僵固性)
**

BH. STICKY WAGES

65. **sticky wages = 工資黏性**

Macroeconomic expression meaning:

- > wages adjust slowly rather than instantly to market changes.

BI. DOWNWARD WAGE RIGIDITY

66. **downward wage rigidity = 工資向下調整困難**

Wages may be harder to cut than to raise.

BJ. EFFICIENCY WAGE

67. **efficiency wage = wage set above some market-clearing/reference level to improve productivity or workforce outcomes (效率工資) **

Economic theories propose that higher wages may, under certain conditions, improve outcomes through mechanisms such as:

- * worker effort;
- * retention;
- * applicant quality;
- * reduced turnover.

Specialist labour economics.

BK. RESERVATION WAGE

68. **reservation wage = lowest wage at which a person is willing to accept a job under specified conditions (保留工資) **

Important labour-economics concept.

It is not:

> the legal minimum wage.

It is:

> the individual's threshold for accepting employment.

BL. EQUILIBRIUM WAGE

69. **equilibrium wage = wage at which labour supply and demand balance in a given model (均衡工資) **

Economic-model term.

BM. MARKET-CLEARING WAGE

70. **market-clearing wage = clears labour market in a specified supply-demand model (市場出清工資) **

Closely related to equilibrium wage.

BN. WAGE DISPERSION

71. **wage dispersion = spread/variation of wages across workers/jobs (工資分散程度) **

BO. WAGE INEQUALITY

72. **wage inequality = 工資不平等**

Differences in wage distribution among workers/groups.

BP. WAGE COMPRESSION

73. **wage compression = narrowing of pay differences between workers/groups (工資差距壓縮) **

For example:

> lower-paid wages rise faster than higher-paid wages.

Can create practical HR issues if:

> junior and experienced roles become too close in pay.

BQ. WAGE GAP

74. **wage gap = difference in average/typical wages between groups (工資差距) **

Examples:

- * gender wage gap;
- * regional wage gap;
- * skill wage gap.

Important:

> a raw wage gap does not by itself establish a particular cause.

The population, measure and adjustment method matter.

BR. GENDER WAGE GAP

75. **gender wage gap = 男女 / 性別工資差距**

Can be measured in different ways:

- * hourly;
- * weekly;
- * annual;
- * median;
- * mean;
- * adjusted/unadjusted.

Therefore figures are not interchangeable without methodology.

BS. SKILL WAGE PREMIUM

76. **skill wage premium = skilled workers' wage advantage over comparison group (技能工資溢價) **

Labour economics.

BT. EDUCATION WAGE PREMIUM

77. **education wage premium = earnings/wage difference associated with higher educational attainment**

Specialist economics/statistics.

Does not automatically prove education alone caused the entire difference.

BU. UNION WAGE PREMIUM

78. **union wage premium = wage difference associated with union-covered/union workers relative to comparison workers**

Again:

> exact estimate depends on method/population.

BV. WAGE INDEXATION

79. **wage indexation = linking wage adjustments to an index such as inflation (工資指數化)

**

Can be:

- * automatic;
- * partial;
- * negotiated.

BW. COST-OF-LIVING ADJUSTMENT

80. **COLA = cost-of-living adjustment**

Not identical to **wage indexation**, but related:

> pay is adjusted in response to cost-of-living/inflation measures.

BX. WAGE DRIFT

81. **wage drift = actual earnings/rates rise above formally negotiated/basic wage rates**

Labour-economics/industrial-relations term.

Possible causes include:

- * overtime;
- * bonuses;
- * labour shortages;
- * local supplements.

Specialist.

BY. WAGE LADDER / PAY LADDER

82. **wage ladder = hierarchy/path of wage levels (工資階梯) **

Used in labour-market and career discussions.

****Pay ladder**** is also common.

BZ. FAMILY WAGE — HISTORICAL/SOCIOLOGICAL

83. ****family wage = wage conceived as sufficient to support a worker and dependants (家庭工資) ****

Historical labour/social-policy concept.

Historically it was often tied to gendered assumptions about a male breadwinner supporting a household, so context matters.

CA. SOCIAL WAGE

84. ****social wage = value of public/social benefits supplementing private earnings (社會工資) ****

Specialist political-economy/social-policy term.

May include things such as:

- * public services;
- * social benefits;
- * transfers,

depending on the author's framework.

CB. WAGE SUBSIDY

85. ****wage subsidy = financial support intended to reduce employment cost or supplement wages (工資補貼) ****

Can be paid to:

- * employer;
- * worker,

depending on programme design.

CC. WAGE REPLACEMENT

86. **wage replacement = benefit replacing part of income lost because person cannot work (工資替代) **

Common in discussions of:

- * unemployment;
- * disability;
- * workers' compensation;
- * parental leave.

CD. WAGE-REPLACEMENT RATE

87. **wage replacement rate = benefit as proportion of previous wages (工資替代率) **

Example:

> benefit equals 60% of prior wage.

Specialist benefits/social-insurance terminology.

CE. WAGE ARREARS

88. **wage arrears = wages owed but not paid on time (欠薪) **

> “Workers are owed three months of wage arrears.”

「工人被拖欠三個月**工資**。」

The ILO specifically identifies delayed/non-payment and wage arrears as wage-protection issues.
([International Labour Organization][6])

CF. UNPAID WAGES

89. **unpaid wages = 未支付工資 / 欠薪**

CG. BACK WAGES / BACK PAY

90. **back wages = 補發欠薪**

Money owed for an earlier period because wages were:

- * not paid;
- * underpaid;
- * unlawfully withheld,

depending on case.

CH. WAGE THEFT

91. **wage theft = unlawful failure to pay workers wages/benefits legally owed (工資盜竊 / 非法欠薪)**

Broad labour-law/advocacy term often applied to conduct such as:

- * unpaid work;
- * illegal deductions;
- * minimum-wage violations;
- * unpaid overtime,

depending on applicable law.

Because precise violations depend on jurisdiction, it should not be applied to a specific employer without facts/legal context.

CI. WAGE DEDUCTION

92. **wage deduction = 從工資扣款**

Possible examples:

- * tax;
- * pension contribution;
- * authorized deductions.

Whether a particular deduction is lawful depends on jurisdiction/contract.

ILO wage-protection standards address limits and conditions around wage deductions and attachment. ([International Labour Organization][7])

CJ. WAGE GARNISHMENT

93. **wage garnishment = court/legal process requiring part of wages to be withheld to satisfy an obligation (工資扣押) **

Common in U.S. legal terminology.

Rules and limits vary by jurisdiction.

CK. WAGE ATTACHMENT

94. **attachment of wages = 扣押工資**

Broader formal/legal expression.

ILO standards recognize that attachment/assignment of wages may be regulated and limited by national law. ([International Labour Organization][7])

CL. ASSIGNMENT OF WAGES

95. **assignment of wages = 將未來 / 應收工資權利轉讓**

Legal/financial term.

Exact validity is jurisdiction-specific.

CM. PAYMENT IN KIND

96. **wages in kind = partly paying wages through goods/services rather than cash (實物工資) **

For example historically:

* food;

* housing.

ILO standards regulate such wage payment arrangements and emphasize fair/reasonable valuation where permitted. ([International Labour Organization][6])

CN. CASH WAGE

97. **cash wage = 現金工資**

Wage component paid in money rather than benefits/in-kind compensation.

CO. FRINGE BENEFITS VS WAGES

wages

direct employment remuneration.

fringe benefits

non-wage compensation such as:

- * health insurance;
- * retirement contribution;
- * paid benefits,

depending on system.

Total compensation can therefore exceed wages.

CP. WAGE AND BENEFITS

98. **wages and benefits = 工資及福利**

A common employment-cost pairing.

CQ. COMPENSATION

99. **wage vs compensation**

wage

direct employment pay.

compensation

broader umbrella that may include:

- * wages/salary;
- * bonuses;
- * benefits;
- * stock awards,

depending on context.

CR. WAGE VS SALARY

A critical learner distinction.

wage

traditionally associated with:

- * hourly/daily/weekly pay;
- * manual/service work;
- * pay varying with hours/output.

salary

fixed periodic pay, usually expressed as annual amount and commonly associated with office/professional employment.

Modern reality overlaps, and labour/accounting data may group:

> **wage and salary workers**

together. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

CS. WAGE VS PAY

pay

most general everyday term for employment compensation.

wage

more specific payment structure/category.

> good pay

> hourly wage.

CT. WAGE VS EARNINGS

wage

rate/payment from employment.

earnings

total amount earned over a period, which may include:

- * wages;
- * overtime;
- * bonuses;
- * commissions,

depending on statistical definition.

CU. WAGE VS INCOME

income

much broader.

May come from:

- * wages;
- * salary;
- * self-employment;
- * investment;
- * rent;
- * benefits.

So:

> all wages are income
> but not all income is wages.

CV. WAGE VS REMUNERATION

remuneration

formal broad compensation for work/services.

wage

a particular common type/form of remuneration.

The ILO's legal-style definition treats wages as remuneration/earnings payable under employment.
([International Labour Organization][7])

CW. WAGE VS FEE

fee

payment for a specific professional/service task.

Examples:

- * lawyer's fee;
- * consultation fee.

wage

employment remuneration.

A freelancer may charge a fee without receiving wages from that customer.

CX. WAGE VS COMMISSION

commission

pay calculated partly/entirely according to sales/results.

wage

often based on hours/time/output.

An employee may receive:

> wage + commission.

CY. WAGE VS BONUS

wage

regular base employment pay.

bonus

additional payment triggered by:

- * performance;
- * company results;
- * discretion;
- * contract terms.

CZ. WAGE VS STIPEND

stipend

fixed allowance/payment, often for:

- * training;
- * study;
- * internship;
- * clergy/research role.

It may not have the same employment-law status as a wage.

DA. WAGE VS HONORARIUM

honorarium

payment given for a service where a standard employment/fee arrangement may not exist.

wage

regular employment compensation.

DB. WAGE = RECOMPENSE / RETURN — FIGURATIVE/OLDER

Now a different semantic branch.

100. **wages = what someone receives as the consequence/recompense of an action (報應 ; 回報) **

Older/literary usage.

The famous fixed expression:

> **“the wages of sin...”**

uses **wages** metaphorically to mean:

> consequence/recompense received for wrongdoing.

Dictionaries still record **wages** in the sense of “recompense, return or requital,” though it is not productive everyday usage. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

DC. **THE WAGES OF SIN**

101. **the wages of sin = wrongdoing's consequences / punishment (罪的報應) **

Biblical/literary expression.

More broadly, speakers may humorously imitate the construction:

> “These headaches are the wages of staying up all night.”

= 「這些頭痛就是通宵的**代價 / 報應**。」

This extended use sounds literary or humorous.

DD. "WAGES" = RETURN / REWARD — ARCHAIC

102. **wages = reward/recompense received for conduct (報酬 ; 報應) — archaic/literary**

Do not generalize this to modern ordinary phrases.

Modern:

> **wages** overwhelmingly means employment pay.

DE. VERB: WAGE A WAR

Now the completely different major branch.

103. **wage war = begin and continue fighting a war (發動 / 進行戰爭) **

> "The two states waged war for years."

「雙方進行了多年的**戰爭**。」

Dictionaries define the verb **wage** as beginning/carrying on a war, battle or organized campaign. ([牛津學習者詞典][8])

DF. **WAGE WAR ON / AGAINST**

104. **wage war on/against X = 對 X 展開戰爭 / 全面鬥爭**

Literal:

> wage war against another country.

Figurative:

> wage war on corruption

> wage war on disease

> wage war on waste.

Meaning:

> conduct a sustained aggressive effort against X.

DG. FIGURATIVE **WAGE WAR ON**

105. **wage war on a problem = vigorously campaign against it (大力打擊) **

> “The company waged war on unnecessary costs.”

「公司大力**削減 / 打擊不必要成本**。」

Strong metaphor.

DH. WAGE A CAMPAIGN

106. **wage a campaign = conduct a sustained organized campaign (展開 / 進行運動) **

> “They waged a campaign to improve safety.”

「他們展開了一場改善安全的**運動**。」

This need not be military.

DI. WAGE A CAMPAIGN AGAINST

107. **wage a campaign against X**

> conduct a sustained effort opposing X.

DJ. WAGE A CAMPAIGN FOR

108. **wage a campaign for X**

Possible:

> wage a campaign for reform.

Here the campaign seeks to achieve X.

DK. WAGE A BATTLE

109. **wage a battle = carry on a serious struggle (進行戰鬥 / 鬥爭) **

Literal or figurative.

> “Doctors are waging a battle against the disease.”

「醫護人員正與疾病展開**鬥爭**。」

DL. WAGE A STRUGGLE

110. **wage a struggle = 進行鬥爭**

Formal and less common than:

> carry on a struggle.

DM. WAGE A FIGHT?

111. **wage a fight**

Possible but less idiomatic than:

* wage war;

* wage a campaign;

* wage a battle.

Often English prefers:

> fight a fight / wage a campaign.

DN. PASSIVE: **BE WAGED**

112. **a war/campaign is being waged = 戰爭 / 運動正在進行**

> “A campaign is being waged against fraud.”

「一場打擊欺詐的運動正在**展開**。」

Very common formal passive.

DO. WAGE WAR VS FIGHT A WAR

fight a war

participate in the fighting.

wage war

conduct/carry on the war as an organized effort.

Large overlap, but **wage** sounds more formal and strategic.

DP. WAGE WAR VS DECLARE WAR

declare war

formally announce a state/intention of war.

wage war

actually conduct the conflict.

One concerns declaration; the other concerns ongoing action.

DQ. WAGE WAR VS START WAR

start

focuses on beginning.

wage

focuses on carrying it on, although dictionary definitions can include beginning and continuing.

DR. WAGE CAMPAIGN VS RUN CAMPAIGN

run a campaign

manage/organize it.

wage a campaign

conduct it vigorously, often against something.

Wage has a stronger conflict metaphor.

DS. WAGE PRICE WAR

113. **wage a price war = aggressively compete by cutting prices**

> “The two retailers waged a price war.”

「兩家零售商展開了**價格戰**。」

Here **war** is commercial, not military.

DT. WAGE TRADE WAR

114. **wage a trade war**

Means conduct a prolonged conflict using:

- * tariffs;
- * restrictions;
- * trade measures,

depending on context.

Again, **war** is metaphorical/economic unless actual armed conflict is also involved.

DU. WAGE LEGAL BATTLE

115. **wage a legal battle = 進行長期法律爭鬥**

> “They waged a long legal battle.”

「他們進行了漫長的**法律爭訟**。」

DV. OLDER/HISTORICAL: WAGE = PLEDGE / SECURITY

116. **wage = pledge/security (抵押 ; 保證物) — obsolete**

Historical dictionaries record **wage** as an obsolete noun meaning a pledge/security. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

This sense survives mainly through:

- * etymology;
- * older texts.

Database priority: very low / historical.

DW. OLDER VERB: WAGE = PLEDGE / BET

117. **wage = pledge or stake something (押上 ; 打賭) — obsolete**

Historically related to:

> wager.

Modern English uses:

> **wager**

rather than *wage* in this sense. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

DX. DIALECTAL/ARCHAIC: WAGE = HIRE

118. **wage = hire/employ someone (僱用) — dialectal/archaic**

Recorded in dictionaries as older/dialectal usage. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

Do not use actively in modern standard English.

DY. WAGELESS

119. **wageless = without wages / not receiving wages (沒有工資的) **

Rare.

> wageless labour

would mean:

> labour performed without wage payment.

Much less common than:

* unpaid;

* unpaid work.

DZ. WAGELESSNESS

120. **wagelessness = condition of not receiving wages — rare**

Extremely low priority.

EA. WAGE SLAVE / WAGE SLAVERY

121. **wage slavery = pejorative ideological term comparing dependence on wage labour to severe economic unfreedom**

繁體中文： often **工資奴役 / 薪資奴役**

This is not a neutral technical synonym for:

> wage employment.

It is a critical political/social characterization used by some writers and movements.

Use attribution/context when discussing actual social systems.

EB. WAGE WORKER VS EMPLOYEE

employee

legal/organizational relationship.

wage worker

emphasizes earning livelihood through wages.

The terms overlap but are not identical in every legal/social framework.

EC. WAGE EARNER VS SALARIED WORKER

wage earner

traditionally hourly/weekly wage worker.

salaried worker

receives fixed salary.

But both belong broadly to:

> employees / wage-and-salary workers

in statistical contexts.

ED. WAGE VS PROFIT

Extremely relevant to Kam Chai.

wage

payment for labour as an employee.

profit

business revenue remaining after relevant expenses.

A café owner may:

> pay staff wages

while hoping the café itself generates:

> profit.

Staff wages are therefore:

> **a cost to the café**

but:

> **income to the employees.**

EE. WAGE VS REVENUE

revenue

money business receives from customers before expenses.

wages

money business pays employees.

So:

> sales revenue → pays rent + wages + ingredients + other costs.

EF. WAGE VS LABOUR COST

As above:

> wages form one part of labour cost.

For the passage:

> **staff wages** are an **operating expense** of the café.

EG. WAGES PAYABLE

122. **wages payable = 工資應付款**

Accounting term:

> wages earned by employees but not yet paid.

Often treated as a current liability.

EH. WAGES EXPENSE

123. **wages expense = 工資費用**

Accounting expense for employee labour during a reporting period.

Depending on accounting system, terms may include:

- * wages expense;
- * salaries expense;
- * payroll expense.

EI. ACCRUED WAGES

124. **accrued wages = 應計工資**

Employees have earned them, but they have not yet been paid/recorded in cash.

EJ. PAYROLL

125. **wages vs payroll**

wages

employee compensation itself.

payroll

can refer to:

- * list of employees/pay;
- * process/system of paying employees;
- * total employee pay amount.

> run payroll

> wages are paid through payroll.

EK. WAGE BILL VS PAYROLL

wage bill

total amount spent on wages.

payroll

can include the wage/salary list/system and total compensation amount.

Large overlap in business reporting.

EL. IMPORTANT GRAMMAR

126. **earn a wage**

> “She earns a good wage.”

「她賺取不錯的工資。」

127. **pay a wage**

> “The café pays a competitive wage.”

「咖啡店支付具競爭力的工資。」

128. **be paid a wage**

> “Workers are paid an hourly wage.”

「工人按時薪支薪。」

129. **live on a wage**

> “It is difficult to live on that wage.”

「靠那份工資生活很困難。」

130. **work for wages**

> “They work for wages rather than profit.”

「他們以受僱取得工資，而非以企業利潤為收入。」

131. **wage of + amount**

> “a wage of \$20 an hour”

132. **wages of + amount**

> “wages of \$800 a week”

possible, especially collective/plural framing.

EM. COUNTABILITY

a wage

Countable/singular when referring to:

> a specific pay rate/amount.

> “a decent wage”

wages

Plural when referring to:

> employment pay received.

> “Wages are rising.”

ECONOMICS **wages**

Often collective plural:

> wages and profits.

FIGURATIVE **wages**

Fixed literary sense:

> the wages of wrongdoing.

EN. VERB GRAMMAR

133. **wage + direct object**

The verb is normally transitive:

> wage war

> wage a campaign

> wage a battle.

134. **wage X against Y**

> “They waged a campaign against corruption.”

135. **wage X on Y**

Especially:

> wage war on poverty

> wage war on waste.

136. **be waged against/on**

Passive:

> “A campaign was waged against the proposal.”

EO. WRONG / UNNATURAL PATTERNS

Do **not** normally say:

> *wage someone* ❌

meaning pay them.

The noun means pay, but the modern verb does **not** mean “pay wages to” in standard English.

Use:

> pay someone.

Do not normally say:

> *I wage \$20 an hour.* ❌

Use:

> I **earn** \$20 an hour.

> My **wage is** \$20 an hour.

EP. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS SUMMARY

wage vs salary

hourly/short-period or variable pay vs fixed salary conventionally.

wage vs pay

specific vs general.

wage vs earnings

rate/payment category vs total amount earned.

wage vs income

employment pay vs all sources of money.

wage vs compensation

direct pay vs broader reward package.

wage vs fee

employee pay vs payment for specific service.

wage vs profit

employee labour income vs owner's/business surplus.

wage vs revenue

business outflow to employees vs business inflow from customers.

wage vs labour cost

wage is one component of broader employer labour costs.

minimum wage vs living wage

legal minimum vs needs-based decent-living concept.

nominal vs real wage

money amount vs purchasing power.

wage as noun vs wage as verb

pay for labour vs conduct sustained conflict/campaign.

EQ. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning	
-----	-----	

wage — employee pay	money paid for labour	
wages	actual/collective employment pay	
wage rate	pay per hour/day/unit	
wage bill	employer's total wage expenditure	
minimum wage	required minimum pay level under applicable system	
living wage	wage intended to support a decent standard of living	
real wage	inflation-adjusted purchasing power of wage	
nominal wage	current money amount of wage	
wage differential/premium	difference or extra amount between wage levels	
wage bargaining/settlement	negotiation/agreement over wages	
wage arrears	overdue unpaid wages	
wage labour	labour exchanged for employment wages	
wage earner	person earning wages	
wage — recompense	consequence/return; literary/older	
wage — verb	carry on a war, campaign, battle or sustained struggle	
wage — pledge/bet/hire	historical/obsolete meanings	
wageless	unpaid; rare	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
-----	-----	
wage — employment	僱主就員工提供勞動而支付的工資 / 薪酬	
wages	員工實際收到 / 應收到的工資，常用複數	
hourly wage	每工作一小時所支付的時薪	
daily/weekly wage	日薪 / 週薪	
wage rate	每單位時間或產量的工資率	
piece-rate wage	按完成件數 / 產量計算的工資	
basic wage	未計額外津貼、加班等前的基本工資	
gross wages	未扣除稅款等前的工資總額	
net wages	扣除相關款項後的淨工資	
low/high wage	低 / 高工資	
minimum wage	法律 / 制度規定僱主至少須支付的工資	
living wage	以能支持工人及家庭體面生活為目標的工資概念	
prevailing wage	某地區 / 職種的通行或制度指定工資水平	
starting wage	入職起薪	
wage increase/rise	加薪 / 工資上升	
wage cut	減薪	
wage freeze	在一段期間不提高工資	
wage cap	工資 / 加薪幅度的上限	
wage floor	不應 / 不得低於的工資下限	
wage bargaining	僱主與工人就工資進行協商	
wage demand/claim	要求加薪；法律語境亦可指工資申索	
wage settlement	談判後達成的工資協議	
wage scale/band	按職級等劃分的工資等級 / 範圍	
wage differential	不同工作 / 群體之間的工資差異	

wage premium	因技能、資格、時段等獲得的額外工資優勢	
wage bill	僱主支付所有員工工資的總額	
wage costs	對僱主而言的工資成本	
wage earner	以僱傭工資為主要勞動收入的人	
wage labour	以提供勞動換取僱主工資的僱傭勞動	
wage employment	受僱於僱主並取得工資的就業	
nominal wage	以當時貨幣金額表示、未調整物價的名義工資	
real wage	按物價 / 通脹調整後反映購買力的實質工資	
wage growth	工資水平隨時間的增長	
wage inflation	廣泛而持續的工資水平上升	
wage-price spiral	工資與物價可能互相推高形成的循環	
wage rigidity / sticky wages	工資對經濟變化調整緩慢的現象	
efficiency wage	為提高生產力、留任等原因而支付較高工資的經濟理論概念	
reservation wage	個人願意接受工作的最低工資門檻	
equilibrium wage	勞動供需在模型中達至平衡的工資	
wage dispersion	工資在不同員工 / 職位之間的分散程度	
wage inequality	工資分布上的不平等	
wage compression	高低工資差距縮小	
wage gap	不同群體 / 職種之間的工資差距	
wage indexation	把工資調整與物價等指數掛鉤	
wage drift	實際工資增長超出正式基本 / 協定工資增幅	
family wage	歷史上被視為足以支持工人及其家庭的工資概念	
social wage	公共服務 / 社會福利等被視為對私人收入的補充；專業概念	
wage subsidy	政府 / 制度用以補貼工資或僱傭成本的支持	
wage replacement	在失業、病假等期間替代部分原工資的福利收入	
wage arrears	已到期但尚未支付的欠薪	
unpaid wages	應付但沒有支付的工資	
back wages	對之前欠付 / 少付期間補發的工資	
wage theft	違法少付、拒付或扣取依法應付工資的概括性用語	
wage deduction	從工資中扣除某筆款項	
wage garnishment	依法從工資扣取部分款項以履行債務 / 法律責任	
wages in kind	以食物、住宿等實物形式支付部分工資	
wages payable	已產生但尚未支付給員工的應付工資	
wages expense	會計上的工資費用	
accrued wages	已由員工賺取但期末尚未支付的應計工資	
wages of X — literary	某行為所得的報應 / 後果；較舊式	
wage war	發動並持續進行戰爭 / 鬥爭	
wage war on X	比喻對 X 展開強力而持續的打擊	
wage a campaign	有組織地展開並持續進行一場運動	
wage a battle/struggle	正式：進行長期戰鬥 / 鬥爭	
be waged	戰爭 / 運動等被持續進行	
wage — pledge/security	古義：抵押 / 保證物	
wage — pledge/bet — verb	古義：押上、打賭、作保	
wage — hire — dialectal	方言 / 古義：僱用	
wageless	沒有工資的；罕用	

For your original passage

> "...rent, renovation costs, staff **wages**, food waste..."

The exact meaning is:

> **wages = the recurring money that the café must pay its employees in return for their labour.**

So from two perspectives:

employee

> wages = **income**

café owner

> staff wages = **operating/labour cost**

That second perspective is what matters in the passage.

The writer is saying that Kam Chai may imagine:

> coffee + pastries + attractive interior

but the actual commercial arithmetic includes:

> sales revenue

> minus rent

> minus staff wages

> minus ingredients

> minus waste

> minus utilities/licensing/other costs

> → whatever profit remains.

So a strong Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **「租金、裝修費、員工工資、食物損耗.....」**

For your database, I would keep **5 principal semantic branches**:

1. **employment pay for labour**
2. **economic/payroll wage level, rate and labour-income concepts**
3. **wages as collective labour compensation / labour's income**
4. **literary/older wages = recompense, return or consequence**
5. **verb wage = conduct and sustain a war, campaign, battle or struggle**

Then index **minimum wage, living wage, nominal/real wage, wage bill, wage differential, wage premium, wage bargaining, wage arrears, wage theft, efficiency wage, reservation wage, wage inflation, wage-price spiral, wage labour, wage earner, wage war**, because these are established enough that a database entry reduced to simply **「工資」** would miss a very large part of the family.

[1]: https://www.ilo.org/resource/15-what-included-minimum-wage?utm_source=chatgpt.com "1.5 What is included in a minimum wage? | International Labour Organization"

[2]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/dictionary/english/wage?utm_source=chatgpt.com "WAGE definition and meaning | Collins English Dictionary"

[3]: https://www.ilo.org/topics/wages/minimum-wages/how-define-minimum-wage?utm_source=chatgpt.com "How to define a minimum wage? | International Labour Organization"

[4]: https://www.ilo.org/topics-and-sectors/wages/living-wages?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Living wages | International Labour Organization"

[5]: https://www.bls.gov/bls/glossary.htm?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Glossary : U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics"

[6]: https://www.ilo.org/international-labour-standards/international-labour-standards-wages?utm_source=chatgpt.com "International Labour Standards on Wages | International Labour Organization"

[7]: https://www.ilo.org/dyn/normlex/en/f?p=NORMLEXPUB%3A12100%3A0%3A%3ANO%3A12100%3AP12100_INSTRUMENT_ID%3A312240%3ANO&utm_source=chatgpt.com "Convention C095 - Protection of Wages Convention, 1949 (No. 95)"

[8]: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/us/definition/english/wage_2?utm_source=chatgpt.com "wage verb - Definition, pictures, pronunciation and usage notes | Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary at OxfordLearnersDictionaries.com"